

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

The Complete Pirc and Modern Defense

Flexible development against 1.e4, central breaks, and counterattacking structures

COURSE BOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

How to Use This Course

ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

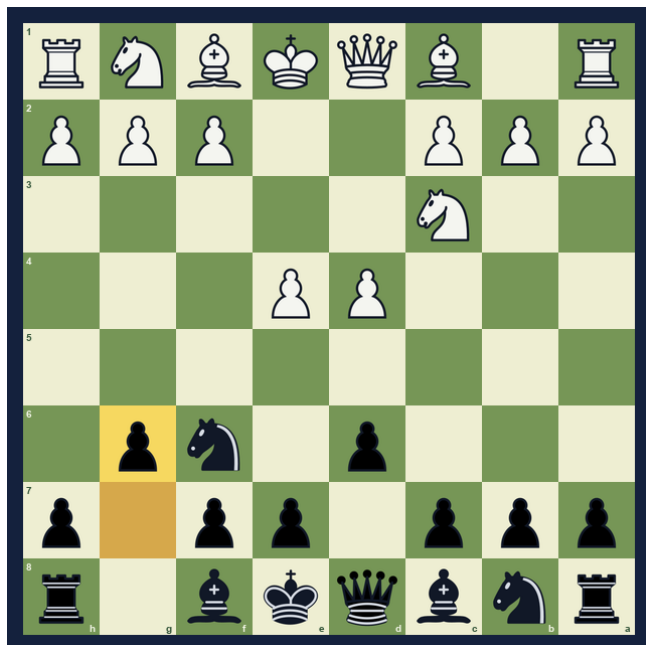
The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

Course Map

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01. Pirc Core Setup - Stage 1



PIRC FOUNDATION

READ THE POSITION

Black has invited a two-pawn center while developing toward a fianchetto.

PRIMARY PLAN

Finish development, then challenge d4 with ...e5 or ...c5 before White consolidates.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants e5, f4, Be3, or queenside castling depending on the chosen system.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6

MEMORY RULE

The Pirc shell must release central counterplay before White's attack becomes effortless.

01. Decision Framework

Pirc Core Setup - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...e5 and ...c5 are the central tools; select one according to White's pieces.
PIECE JOB	The f6-knight pressures e4 while the g7-bishop waits for the center to open.
TACTICAL WARNING	Castling does not end the danger; White may already be assembling pieces against g7 and h6.
TRADE FILTER	Trade central pawns when it reduces White's space and activates Black's pieces.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use opening speed until White creates a forcing center or a direct king attack.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The Pirc shell must release central counterplay before White's attack becomes effortless.

02. Pirc Core Setup - Stage 2



PIRC FOUNDATION

READ THE POSITION

Black is castled, but White's center still demands a timely challenge.

PRIMARY PLAN

Finish development, then challenge d4 with ...e5 or ...c5 before White consolidates.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants e5, f4, Be3, or queenside castling depending on the chosen system.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O

MEMORY RULE

The Pirc shell must release central counterplay before White's attack becomes effortless.

02. Decision Framework

Pirc Core Setup - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...e5 and ...c5 are the central tools; select one according to White's pieces.
PIECE JOB	The f6-knight pressures e4 while the g7-bishop waits for the center to open.
TACTICAL WARNING	Castling does not end the danger; White may already be assembling pieces against g7 and h6.
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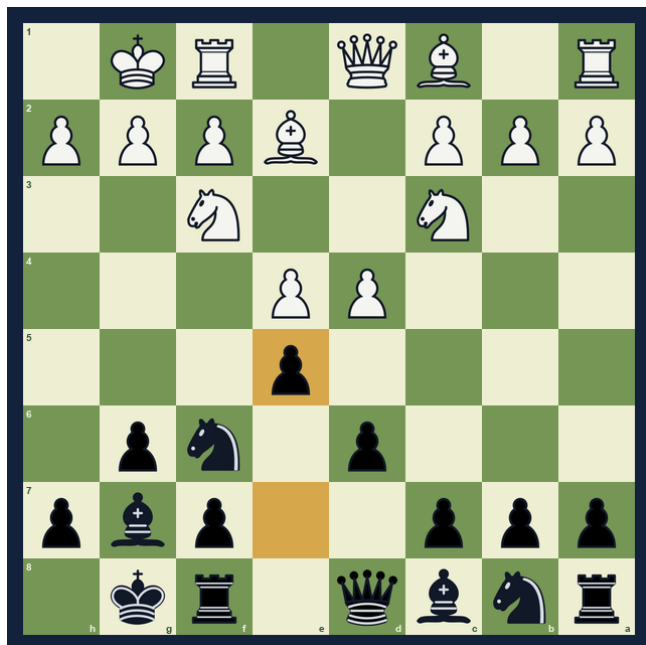
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The Pirc shell must release central counterplay before White's attack becomes effortless.

03. Classical Pirc with ...e5 - Stage 1



PIRC CLASSICAL

READ THE POSITION

Black has challenged d4 in a normally developed Classical Pirc.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete queenside development and use the open center before White creates a new space advantage.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to maintain e4, use central files, and exploit any weak dark squares.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O 6. O-O e5

MEMORY RULE

After ...e5 opens the center, development replaces the pawn storm as Black's priority.

03. Decision Framework

Classical Pirc with ...e5 - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...e5 is successful when Black can meet the central resolution with active pieces.
PIECE JOB	The c8-bishop, queen's knight, and rooks must enter quickly after the center opens.
TACTICAL WARNING	Check whether a central capture exposes the f6-knight, queen, or g7-bishop to tactics.
TRADE FILTER	Central exchanges are welcome when Black gains activity rather than merely reaching a passive ending.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate the forcing capture sequence once; then return to rapid development.

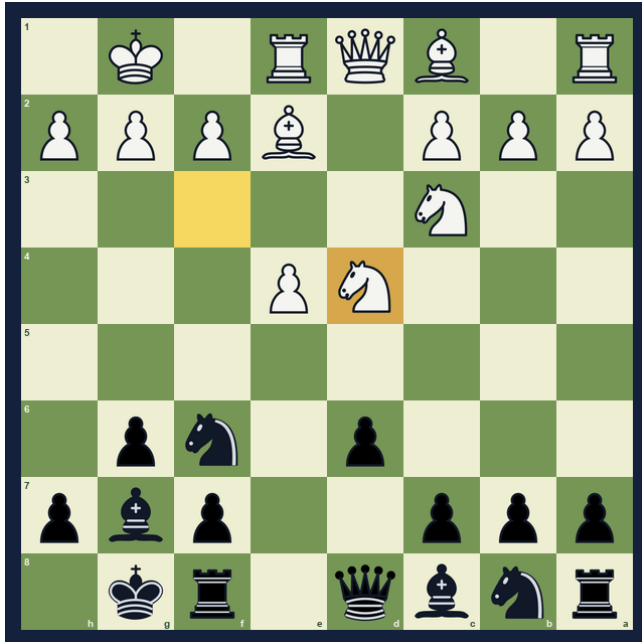
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: After ...e5 opens the center, development replaces the pawn storm as Black's priority.

04. Classical Pirc with ...e5 - Stage 2



PIRC CLASSICAL

READ THE POSITION

Central exchanges have reduced White's space and opened files.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete queenside development and use the open center before White creates a new space advantage.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to maintain e4, use central files, and exploit any weak dark squares.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O 6. O-O e5 7. Re1 exd4 8. Nxd4

MEMORY RULE

After ...e5 opens the center, development replaces the pawn storm as Black's priority.

04. Decision Framework

Classical Pirc with ...e5 - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...e5 is successful when Black can meet the central resolution with active pieces.
PIECE JOB	The c8-bishop, queen's knight, and rooks must enter quickly after the center opens.
TACTICAL WARNING	Check whether a central capture exposes the f6-knight, queen, or g7-bishop to tactics.
TRADE FILTER	Central exchanges are welcome when Black gains activity rather than merely reaching a passive ending.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate the forcing capture sequence once; then return to rapid development.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: After ...e5 opens the center, development replaces the pawn storm as Black's priority.

05. Pirc with ...c5 - Stage 1



PIRC CENTRAL BREAKS

READ THE POSITION

Black has attacked d4 from the flank with ...c5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use open c- and e-files, pressure d5, and develop with tempo against the center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to preserve the space wedge and use e5 or queenside expansion.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O 6. O-O c5

MEMORY RULE

With ...c5, Black attacks d4 first and decides the rest after White responds.

05. Decision Framework

Pirc with ...c5 - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 fixes the target; ...e6 attacks its base after d5.
PIECE JOB	The queen's knight and g7-bishop gain scope when central pawns exchange.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch d5-e6 tactics and make sure Black can recapture without losing the f6-knight.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange central pawns if the resulting open lines reward Black's development.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	This is a forcing structural decision; calculate the likely captures, then play efficiently.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: With ...c5, Black attacks d4 first and decides the rest after White responds.

06. Pirc with ...c5 - Stage 2



PIRC CENTRAL BREAKS

READ THE POSITION

White has advanced d5 and Black is challenging the pawn chain with ...e6.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use open c- and e-files, pressure d5, and develop with tempo against the center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to preserve the space wedge and use e5 or queenside expansion.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O 6. O-O c5 7. d5 e6

MEMORY RULE

With ...c5, Black attacks d4 first and decides the rest after White responds.

06. Decision Framework

Pirc with ...c5 - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 fixes the target; ...e6 attacks its base after d5.
PIECE JOB	The queen's knight and g7-bishop gain scope when central pawns exchange.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch d5-e6 tactics and make sure Black can recapture without losing the f6-knight.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange central pawns if the resulting open lines reward Black's development.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	This is a forcing structural decision; calculate the likely captures, then play efficiently.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: With ...c5, Black attacks d4 first and decides the rest after White responds.

07. Austrian Attack - Stage 1



PIRC WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White has built an aggressive d4-e4-f4 center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Create immediate central contact and force White to solve problems away from Black's king.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants e5, rapid development, and direct kingside pressure.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. f4 Bg7 5. Nf3 O-O

MEMORY RULE

Against the Austrian, answer the wing threat by making the center urgent.

07. Decision Framework

Austrian Attack - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 is the main practical challenge; ...e6 follows when d5 becomes the fixed target.
PIECE JOB	The f6-knight and g7-bishop must attack the center while Black develops the queenside.
TACTICAL WARNING	Check e5 advances, sacrifices near e6 or f7, and tactical attacks on the castled king.
TRADE FILTER	Trade central pawns or queens when it neutralizes White's attack without conceding a dead position.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Count forcing threats against your king, then calculate the central counterstrike-not every pawn push.

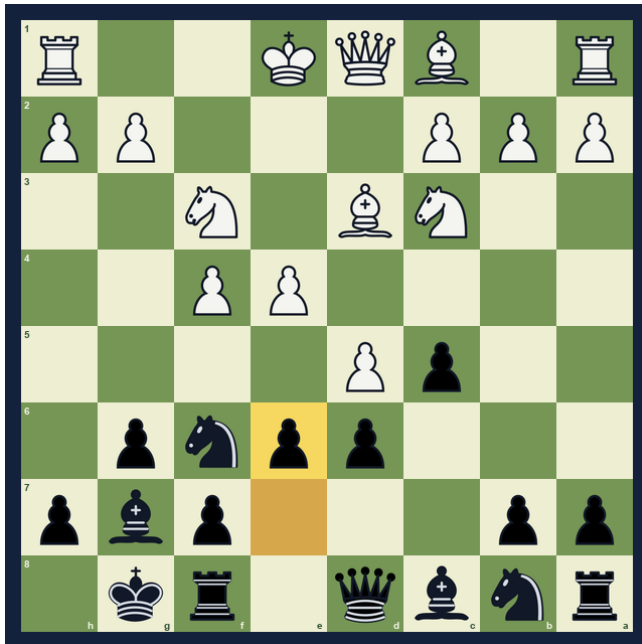
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Austrian, answer the wing threat by making the center urgent.

08. Austrian Attack - Stage 2



PIRC WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Black has struck at d4 and d5 before White completes the attack.

PRIMARY PLAN

Create immediate central contact and force White to solve problems away from Black's king.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants e5, rapid development, and direct kingside pressure.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. f4 Bg7 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Bd3 c5 7. d5 e6

MEMORY RULE

Against the Austrian, answer the wing threat by making the center urgent.

08. Decision Framework

Austrian Attack - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 is the main practical challenge; ...e6 follows when d5 becomes the fixed target.
PIECE JOB	The f6-knight and g7-bishop must attack the center while Black develops the queenside.
TACTICAL WARNING	Check e5 advances, sacrifices near e6 or f7, and tactical attacks on the castled king.
TRADE FILTER	Trade central pawns or queens when it neutralizes White's attack without conceding a dead position.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Count forcing threats against your king, then calculate the central counterstrike-not every pawn push.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Austrian, answer the wing threat by making the center urgent.

09. 150 Attack - Stage 1



PIRC WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White has built the Be3-Qd2 battery and is preparing long castling.

PRIMARY PLAN

Challenge the center and create queenside lines toward White's intended king.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to trade the g7-bishop, castle long, and advance the h- and g-pawns.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Be3 Bg7 5. Qd2 O-O 6. f3

MEMORY RULE

Against the 150 Attack, central stability gives permission for queenside speed.

09. Decision Framework

150 Attack - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use ...e5 or ...c6 followed by ...b5; the center must support the queenside operation.
PIECE JOB	The c8-bishop, queen, and queenside rook need open lines while the g7-bishop protects the king.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch sacrifices on h6 and g7, and do not allow the fianchetto bishop to disappear without calculation.
TRADE FILTER	A queen trade often favors Black if it ends White's attack and leaves playable central activity.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Verify whether White has a forcing sacrifice now; if not, use the tempo for counterplay.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the 150 Attack, central stability gives permission for queenside speed.

10. 150 Attack - Stage 2



PIRC WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Both sides have begun a direct opposite-wing race.

PRIMARY PLAN

Challenge the center and create queenside lines toward White's intended king.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to trade the g7-bishop, castle long, and advance the h- and g-pawns.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Be3 Bg7 5. Qd2 O-O 6. f3 c6 7. O-O-O b5 8. h4

MEMORY RULE

Against the 150 Attack, central stability gives permission for queenside speed.

10. Decision Framework

150 Attack - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use ...e5 or ...c6 followed by ...b5; the center must support the queenside operation.
PIECE JOB	The c8-bishop, queen, and queenside rook need open lines while the g7-bishop protects the king.
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NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the 150 Attack, central stability gives permission for queenside speed.

11. Classical Pirc with ...c6 - Stage 1



PIRC CLASSICAL

READ THE POSITION

Black has used ...c6 to support flexible central and queenside play.

PRIMARY PLAN

Prepare ...e5, consider ...b5, and finish development without losing central urgency.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to restrain queenside expansion and preserve a stable center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O 6. O-O c6

MEMORY RULE

...c6 preserves choices; it does not excuse postponing the central challenge.

11. Decision Framework

Classical Pirc with ...c6 - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...e5 is the usual central goal; ...b5 is useful only when development and tactics permit it.
PIECE JOB	The b8-knight may use a6 because c6 is occupied and the piece can influence b4 or c5.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not let flexible preparation become passive waiting while White improves every piece.
TRADE FILTER	Keep pieces when they support the central break; simplify if it removes White's pressure cleanly.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use quick moves for known development, but pause before committing ...e5 or ...b5.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: ...c6 preserves choices; it does not excuse postponing the central challenge.

12. Classical Pirc with ...c6 - Stage 2



PIRC CLASSICAL

READ THE POSITION

White has restrained ...b5, and Black has developed the knight through a6.

PRIMARY PLAN

Prepare ...e5, consider ...b5, and finish development without losing central urgency.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to restrain queenside expansion and preserve a stable center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O 6. O-O c6 7. a4 a5 8. Re1 Na6

MEMORY RULE

...c6 preserves choices; it does not excuse postponing the central challenge.

12. Decision Framework

Classical Pirc with ...c6 - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...e5 is the usual central goal; ...b5 is useful only when development and tactics permit it.
PIECE JOB	The b8-knight may use a6 because c6 is occupied and the piece can influence b4 or c5.
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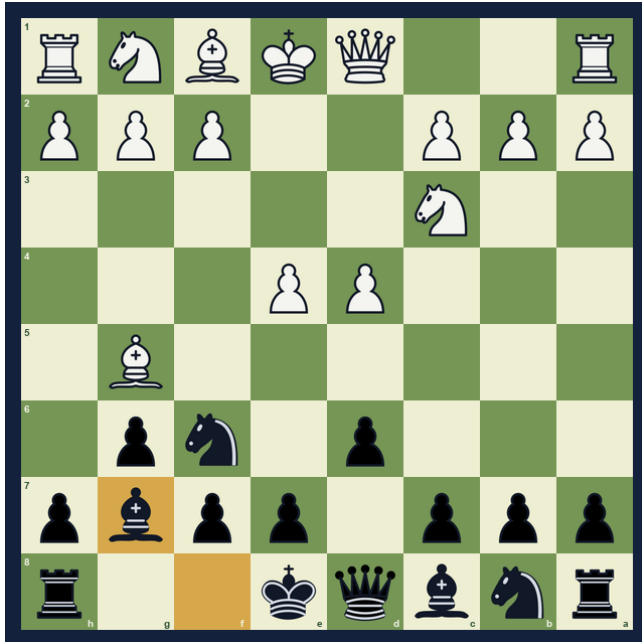
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: ...c6 preserves choices; it does not excuse postponing the central challenge.

13. Early Bishop Systems - Stage 1



PIRC WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White's early Bg5 creates pins and discourages comfortable central breaks.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development and challenge the center without walking into a pin or bishop exchange tactic.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to inconvenience ...e5, trade on g7, or gain time for an attack.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Bg5 Bg7

MEMORY RULE

An early bishop changes tactics first; it changes strategy only when the center also changes.

13. Decision Framework

Early Bishop Systems - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Select ...e5, ...c5, or ...c6 only after checking how the bishop changes the tactics.
PIECE JOB	The queen, f6-knight, and g7-bishop are geometrically linked to White's bishop placement.
TACTICAL WARNING	Pins may make a normally sound central capture fail because a defender cannot move.
TRADE FILTER	Trade the active white bishop when it removes pressure without surrendering Black's key defender.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause at the bishop move, calculate the pin, then return to the central plan.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: An early bishop changes tactics first; it changes strategy only when the center also changes.

14. Early Bishop Systems - Stage 2



PIRC WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White's Be3-Qd2 battery signals pressure on the fianchetto.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development and challenge the center without walking into a pin or bishop exchange tactic.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to inconvenience ...e5, trade on g7, or gain time for an attack.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Be3 Bg7 5. Qd2 O-O

MEMORY RULE

An early bishop changes tactics first; it changes strategy only when the center also changes.

14. Decision Framework

Early Bishop Systems - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Select ...e5, ...c5, or ...c6 only after checking how the bishop changes the tactics.
PIECE JOB	The queen, f6-knight, and g7-bishop are geometrically linked to White's bishop placement.
TACTICAL WARNING	Pins may make a normally sound central capture fail because a defender cannot move.
TRADE FILTER	Trade the active white bishop when it removes pressure without surrendering Black's key defender.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
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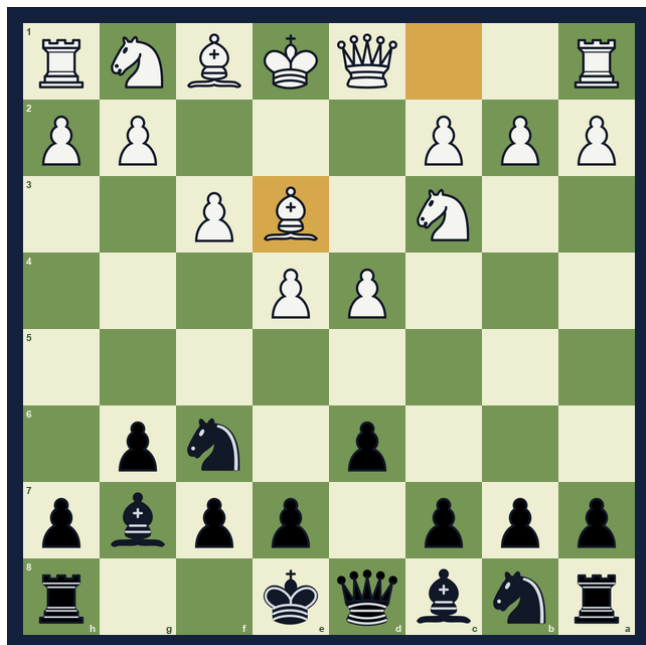
ACTIVE RECALL

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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: An early bishop changes tactics first; it changes strategy only when the center also changes.

15. Pirc f3 Systems - Stage 1



PIRC WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White has reinforced e4 with f3 and kept several attacking setups available.

PRIMARY PLAN

Challenge d4, open queenside lines if White castles long, and avoid a passive kingside defense.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants g4, h4, Be3, Qd2, and a direct attack after securing the center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. f3 Bg7 5. Be3

MEMORY RULE

f3 strengthens e4 but also announces where White may place the king and pawns.

15. Decision Framework

Pirc f3 Systems - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c6 and ...b5 gain purpose after long castling; ...e5 remains a central option.
PIECE JOB	The queenside pawns and rook create counterplay while the g7-bishop guards critical dark squares.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch central sacrifices and h-file attacks before assuming queenside play is fast enough.
TRADE FILTER	Trade queens when safe because White has invested heavily in an attacking formation.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Compare the speed of White's h-pawn with Black's queenside file opening before choosing a move.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: f3 strengthens e4 but also announces where White may place the king and pawns.

16. Pirc f3 Systems - Stage 2



PIRC WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White has castled long and Black has begun queenside expansion.

PRIMARY PLAN

Challenge d4, open queenside lines if White castles long, and avoid a passive kingside defense.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants g4, h4, Be3, Qd2, and a direct attack after securing the center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. f3 Bg7 5. Be3 O-O 6. Qd2 c6 7. O-O-O b5

MEMORY RULE

f3 strengthens e4 but also announces where White may place the king and pawns.

16. Decision Framework

Pirc f3 Systems - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c6 and ...b5 gain purpose after long castling; ...e5 remains a central option.
PIECE JOB	The queenside pawns and rook create counterplay while the g7-bishop guards critical dark squares.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch central sacrifices and h-file attacks before assuming queenside play is fast enough.
TRADE FILTER	Trade queens when safe because White has invested heavily in an attacking formation.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Compare the speed of White's h-pawn with Black's queenside file opening before choosing a move.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: f3 strengthens e4 but also announces where White may place the king and pawns.

17. Pirc Queenside Counterplay - Stage 1



PIRC ATTACKING PLAY

READ THE POSITION

Black has prepared queenside expansion while White prepares long castling.

PRIMARY PLAN

Open lines toward the long-castled king while monitoring White's faster kingside threats.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants h4-h5, bishop exchanges, and sacrifices against Black's pawn shield.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Be3 Bg7 5. Qd2 O-O 6. f3 c6

MEMORY RULE

Queenside space matters only when it opens lines for Black's pieces.

17. Decision Framework

Pirc Queenside Counterplay - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...b5-b4 gains time on the knight; ...e5 or ...c5 may still be required in the center.
PIECE JOB	The b-file rook, queen, and c8-bishop must follow the pawns into the attack.
TACTICAL WARNING	A queenside pawn advance can fail if White opens the center with check or lands a kingside sacrifice first.
TRADE FILTER	Avoid queen trades only when Black's attack is stronger; otherwise simplification often favors the defender.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Count forcing moves on both kings before pushing another pawn in the race.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Queenside space matters only when it opens lines for Black's pieces.

18. Pirc Queenside Counterplay - Stage 2



PIRC ATTACKING PLAY

READ THE POSITION

...b4 has gained space and attacked the c3-knight near White's king.

PRIMARY PLAN

Open lines toward the long-castled king while monitoring White's faster kingside threats.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants h4-h5, bishop exchanges, and sacrifices against Black's pawn shield.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Be3 Bg7 5. Qd2 O-O 6. f3 c6 7. O-O-O b5 8. h4 b4

MEMORY RULE

Queenside space matters only when it opens lines for Black's pieces.

18. Decision Framework

Pirc Queenside Counterplay - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...b5-b4 gains time on the knight; ...e5 or ...c5 may still be required in the center.
PIECE JOB	The b-file rook, queen, and c8-bishop must follow the pawns into the attack.
TACTICAL WARNING	A queenside pawn advance can fail if White opens the center with check or lands a kingside sacrifice first.
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ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Count forcing moves on both kings before pushing another pawn in the race.

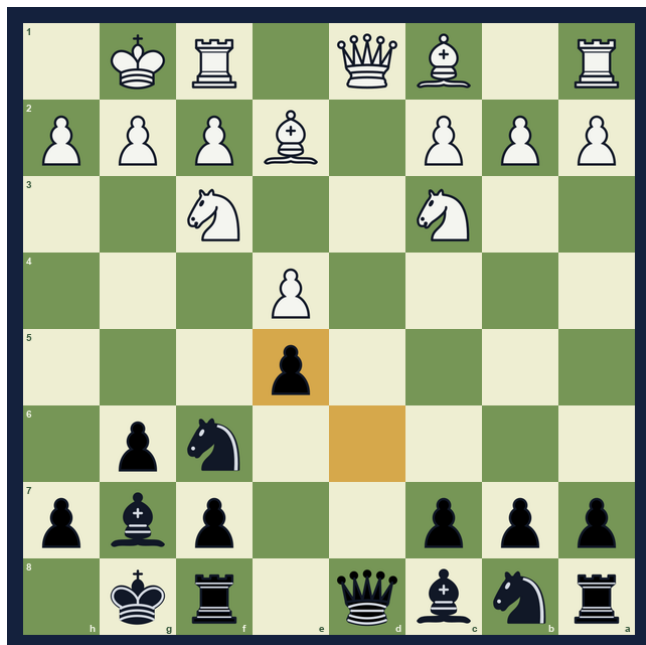
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Queenside space matters only when it opens lines for Black's pieces.

19. Pirc Central Simplification - Stage 1



PIRC ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

White has exchanged in the center and reduced the attacking character.

PRIMARY PLAN

Activate the queenside pieces, centralize rooks, and prevent a lasting white space edge.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants a risk-free endgame with slightly easier development and pressure on weak squares.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O 6. O-O e5 7. dxe5 dxe5

MEMORY RULE

When queens leave, replace attack patterns with activity and endgame structure.

19. Decision Framework

Pirc Central Simplification - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use pawn breaks to free pieces and create targets, not to recreate a vanished kingside attack.
PIECE JOB	The c8-bishop and b8-knight must become active before White occupies the open files.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch tactics on the e-file and loose central pawns after queen exchanges.
TRADE FILTER	Trade when it improves the remaining minor piece or removes White's pressure; activity is the standard.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Play routine development quickly, but calculate pawn endings and irreversible exchanges carefully.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When queens leave, replace attack patterns with activity and endgame structure.

20. Pirc Central Simplification - Stage 2



PIRC ENDGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Queens are off and Black has centralized a rook in a playable endgame.

PRIMARY PLAN

Activate the queenside pieces, centralize rooks, and prevent a lasting white space edge.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants a risk-free endgame with slightly easier development and pressure on weak squares.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O 6. O-O e5 7. dxe5 dxe5 8. Qxd8 Rxd8 9. Bg5 Re8

MEMORY RULE

When queens leave, replace attack patterns with activity and endgame structure.

20. Decision Framework

Pirc Central Simplification - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use pawn breaks to free pieces and create targets, not to recreate a vanished kingside attack.
PIECE JOB	The c8-bishop and b8-knight must become active before White occupies the open files.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch tactics on the e-file and loose central pawns after queen exchanges.
TRADE FILTER	Trade when it improves the remaining minor piece or removes White's pressure; activity is the standard.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Play routine development quickly, but calculate pawn endings and irreversible exchanges carefully.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When queens leave, replace attack patterns with activity and endgame structure.

Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.